Accident & Incident Reporting Procedure

Field	Detail
Company	Indus Freight Lines (Pvt.) Ltd.
Document ID	IFL-SAF-005
Version	1.0
Effective date	1 March 2026
Supersedes	Incident sections of IFL-OPS-003 v1.1 and IFL-SAF-004 v1.0
Owner	HSE Manager
Approved by	COO
Next review date	1 March 2027
Applies to	All employees at all locations, including drivers on the road

1. Introduction

1.1 **Purpose.** This procedure explains how to respond to, report, investigate and learn from accidents, incidents and near-misses at Indus Freight Lines (Pvt.) Ltd. ("the Company").

1.2 **Scope.** It covers: - road traffic accidents involving Company vehicles or drivers; - injuries, property damage and dangerous occurrences at the Lahore warehouse, loading bays, fleet yard and Karachi head office; - cargo loss, damage or theft; - vehicle theft or hijacking; - near-misses.

1.3 IT security incidents are reported under IFL-IT-006 using Form IT-03, not this procedure, unless they also involve physical harm or vehicle tracking failure during a trip.

1.4 **Related documents** - IFL-HR-001 HR & Leave Policy (injury-on-duty leave, §8.8) - IFL-HR-002 Code of Conduct (alcohol and drugs, gross misconduct) - IFL-OPS-003 Driver Handbook (breakdowns and accidents, §8) - IFL-SAF-004 Warehouse Safety SOPs (warehouse incident steps, §8)

2. Definitions

Term	Meaning
Incident	Any unplanned event that caused, or could have caused, injury, damage, loss or harm.
Accident	An incident that caused injury, ill health, or damage to property or cargo.
Near-miss	An incident that did not cause injury or

Term	Meaning
	damage but could have.
Dangerous occurrence	A serious event with no injury, such as a racking collapse, fire, load falling from a vehicle or forklift tipping over.
Road traffic accident (RTA)	Any collision or rollover involving a Company vehicle on a public road or at a customer site.
First-aid case	An injury treated with first aid only, with the person returning to work the same shift.
Lost-time injury	An injury that keeps the person off work for at least one full shift after the day of injury.
Reporter	The person completing Form INC-01.
Lead investigator	The person responsible for completing Form INC-02 (see Table 8.1).
Third party	Anyone who is not a Company employee, including members of the public, customers and other drivers.

3. Incident Classification

3.1 Every incident is classified by the highest level that applies. The Control Room or shift desk gives a provisional level at the time of notification. The HSE Manager confirms the level within 24 hours.

Table 3.1 – Severity levels

Level	Name	Examples / thresholds
1	Minor	First-aid case; property or vehicle damage below PKR 50,000; cargo damage below PKR 100,000
2	Moderate	Medical treatment beyond first aid; lost time of 1–3 days; property damage PKR 50,000–500,000; cargo damage PKR 100,000–1,000,000
3	Serious	Hospital admission over 24 hours; lost time over 3 days; any third-party injury; property damage above PKR 500,000; cargo loss or damage above PKR 1,000,000; vehicle

Level	Name	Examples / thresholds
		theft or hijacking; any dangerous occurrence
4	Critical	Fatality; 2 or more people with serious injuries; fire requiring building evacuation; hazardous spill affecting the public

3.2 If the level is unclear, the incident is treated at the higher level until the HSE Manager decides otherwise.

4. Immediate Response

4.1 **General steps (all locations)** 1. Make the scene safe and protect yourself first. 2. Call emergency services if anyone is seriously injured, or if there is a fire or spill. 3. Give first aid if trained. 4. Notify as set out in §5. 5. Preserve the scene. Do not move vehicles, equipment or goods unless needed to protect people or to clear a public road on police instruction. 6. Take photos (wide view, close-ups of damage, number plates, road signs and conditions) using the Company app or phone.

4.2 **Road traffic accidents (drivers)** - 4.2.1 Stop the vehicle, switch on hazard lights and place warning triangles as set out in IFL-OPS-003 §8.1. - 4.2.2 Inform the police for any accident involving injury, or where the other party disputes the facts. - 4.2.3 Collect the other party's name, CNIC number, phone number, vehicle registration and insurance details, if available. - 4.2.4 Do not admit liability, sign anything other than an official police document, or agree any private payment or settlement. - 4.2.5 If there is a risk of violence from a crowd, leave the scene as soon as it is safe, drive to the nearest police station or approved stop and inform the Control Room. Leaving under these conditions is not a breach of this procedure.

4.3 **Warehouse and yard.** Follow IFL-SAF-004 §8.1, including notifying the shift desk (ext. 241) and the HSE emergency line (ext. 299) where required.

4.4 **Karachi head office.** Inform the Admin Officer – Karachi through reception (ext. 100), who informs the HSE Manager by phone and at safety@indusfreight.example.

5. Notification and Reporting Timelines

5.1 **Internal notification**

Table 5.1 – Who to tell, and by when

Step	Who	To whom	Deadline
Verbal notification – drivers and yard	Driver / person involved	Control Room (ext. 222)	Immediately; no later than 1 hour after the event

Step	Who	To whom	Deadline
Verbal notification – warehouse	Person involved or witness	Shift desk (ext. 241)	Immediately
Escalation – Level 3 or 4	Control Room or shift desk	HSE Manager and COO (by phone)	Within 2 hours
Escalation – Level 2	Control Room or shift desk	HSE Manager / HSE Officer	Within 4 hours
Escalation – Level 1	Shift desk	HSE Officer	By end of shift
Written report – Form INC-01	Reporter	incidents@indusfreight.example	Within 24 hours
Witness statements – Form INC-03	Each witness	HSE Officer	Within 48 hours
Investigation report – Form INC-02	Lead investigator	HSE Manager	See §8.3

5.2 **Night-time and holidays** - 5.2.1 For incidents between 23:00 and 07:00, or on Sundays and public holidays, the Control Room is the single point of contact. - 5.2.2 Level 1 and 2 incidents during these periods may be escalated to the HSE Manager by 09:00 on the next working day. - 5.2.3 Level 3 and 4 incidents must be escalated within 2 hours at any time, including at night and on public holidays. The HSE Manager keeps an on-call rota for Eid and other holiday periods, which the Control Room holds.

5.3 **When the reporter cannot report** - 5.3.1 If the person involved is hospitalised or otherwise unable to complete INC-01, their supervisor (or for drivers, the Dispatch Supervisor) completes it within the 24-hour deadline. - 5.3.2 The injured person adds their own statement on Form INC-03 within 3 working days of returning to work.

5.4 **External notifications.** These are made by the roles below. Employees must not contact insurers, customers or the media themselves.

Notification	Responsible role	Deadline
Police (where not already involved)	Fleet Manager / HSE Manager	As required by applicable law
Vehicle and cargo insurer	Finance Manager	Within 48 hours
Customer (cargo damage, loss or delay over 6 hours)	Commercial Manager	Within 4 hours of the Control Room confirming the issue
Government authorities (serious injury, fatality)	HSE Manager	As required by applicable law
Family of injured employee	HR Manager	As soon as practical, for Level 3 and 4
Media	CEO or nominee only	—

5.5 **Late reporting** - 5.5.1 Failing to report an accident involving injury or third-party damage within the deadlines in Table 5.1 is gross misconduct under IFL-HR-002 §9.4. - 5.5.2 An injury reported more than 7 days after it happened is treated as ordinary sick leave rather than injury-on-duty leave, unless the HSE Manager accepts the reason for the delay (see IFL-HR-001 §8.8.2). - 5.5.3 Late reports are still accepted and investigated. A late report is never a reason not to report.

6. Post-Incident Testing, Removal and Clearance

6.1 **When testing applies.** Alcohol and drug testing is carried out for: - any driver involved in an RTA, whatever its level; - any forklift operator involved in a Level 2 or higher incident; - any other employee involved in a Level 3 or 4 incident, where the HSE Manager decides testing is appropriate.

6.2 **Timing** - 6.2.1 Tests must be carried out within 4 hours of the incident, at the Lahore site by the HSE Officer or at an approved laboratory. - 6.2.2 For drivers more than 150 km from Lahore, the test is carried out within 8 hours at the nearest approved laboratory or hospital arranged by the Control Room. - 6.2.3 Testing is not delayed for medical treatment. Medical treatment always comes first.

6.3 **Refusal.** Refusing a test, or deliberately delaying it, is treated as a positive result under IFL-HR-002 §9.4.

6.4 **Removal from duty** - 6.4.1 Drivers involved in any RTA, and forklift operators involved in any incident with injury or damage, are removed from driving or forklift duties until cleared under §6.5. - 6.4.2 During removal, the employee receives full pay and may be given other duties. - 6.4.3 A positive test result leads to suspension under IFL-HR-002 §9.4.1.

6.5 **Clearance** - 6.5.1 The HSE Manager clears the employee to return to duty in writing once the test result is negative and the initial findings do not show driver or operator fault. - 6.5.2 For Level 1 and 2 incidents, clearance is normally given within 3 working days. - 6.5.3 Where the investigation finds the employee was at fault, clearance may require refresher training, a repeat road assessment (see IFL-OPS-003 §2.4) or a forklift practical test (see IFL-SAF-004 §3.2) before return. - 6.5.4 After any injury to the driver, a fitness-to-work note is also required (see IFL-OPS-003 §2.6.3).

7. Near-Miss Reporting

7.1 **Why it matters.** Near-misses show where the next accident may happen. All employees are expected to report them.

7.2 **How to report** - 7.2.1 Use Form INC-04 (Near-Miss Report), within 48 hours of the near-miss. - 7.2.2 Reports can be submitted through HRIS, by email to incidents@indusfreight.example, or on paper. - 7.2.3 Anonymous reports can be placed in the drop box at the Lahore shift desk.

7.3 **No blame.** Near-miss reports are not used for disciplinary action against the reporter. This does not apply where the reporter deliberately broke a safety rule or caused the near-miss through wilful misconduct.

7.4 **Review.** The HSE Officer reviews all near-misses weekly and presents trends at the monthly safety meeting.

7.5 **Recognition.** The most useful safety observation each month earns its reporter a PKR 5,000 award, paid through payroll. Anonymous reporters are not eligible.

8. Investigation

8.1 **Lead investigator**

Table 8.1 – Lead investigator by level

Level	Lead investigator	Supported by
1	Line supervisor (Warehouse, Fleet or Dispatch Supervisor)	HSE Officer if needed
2	HSE Officer	Line supervisor
3	HSE Manager	Department manager of the area involved
4	Panel appointed by the COO, led by the HSE Manager	Department manager; external expert if required

8.1.1 No investigator may investigate an incident involving themselves or a relative (see IFL-HR-002 §5.4).

8.2 **Method** - 8.2.1 Investigators collect photos, tracker and dashcam data, FLT-01, FLT-02 and WHS-01 records, CCTV, and witness statements (INC-03). - 8.2.2 Tracker and dashcam data must be downloaded by the Control Room within 24 hours of the incident and kept unchanged. - 8.2.3 Root causes are identified using the “5 Whys” method, considering people, equipment, procedures, environment and supervision.

8.3 **Deadlines** - 8.3.1 Investigations for Levels 1–3 must be completed and the INC-02 submitted to the HSE Manager within 7 calendar days. - 8.3.2 Level 4 investigations must be completed within 21 calendar days. An interim report goes to the COO within 7 days. - 8.3.3 If an investigation depends on a police report or insurer survey that is not yet available, the HSE Manager may extend the deadline once by up to 14 days. The extension is recorded on the INC-02.

8.4 **Corrective actions** - 8.4.1 Each corrective action on the INC-02 has a named owner and a deadline, normally no more than 30 days. - 8.4.2 The HSE Officer tracks open actions. Actions overdue by more than 14 days are escalated to the COO.

8.5 **Discipline.** The purpose of an investigation is to find causes, not to blame. Where an investigation finds a breach of rules, the matter is passed to HR and handled under IFL-HR-002 §9.

9. Third Parties, Insurance and Settlements

9.1 **Liability.** Only the Finance Manager, working with the insurer, may accept liability or agree compensation on behalf of the Company.

9.2 **Settlement approval.** Settlements with third parties follow the Company's financial authority limits:

Settlement amount (PKR)	Approved by
Up to 250,000	Fleet Manager (vehicle) or Warehouse Manager (cargo), with Finance Manager agreement
250,001 – 500,000	Finance Manager
500,001 – 2,500,000	COO
Above 2,500,000	CEO

9.3 **Drivers' costs.** Drivers do not pay third-party claims personally, except where the investigation finds gross negligence (for example, driving under the influence or more than 30 km/h above the posted limit). In such cases, recovery follows IFL-HR-002 §9.2.2.

9.4 **Injured employees.** Emergency treatment for employees injured at work is paid by the Company at the nearest suitable hospital. Costs are then claimed against the group IPD insurance; any amount above the insured limit for a work injury is paid by the Company. Injury-on-duty leave is covered in IFL-HR-001 §8.8.

10. Records and Review

10.1 **Records** - 10.1.1 INC-01, INC-02, INC-03 and INC-04 records are kept by the HSE Officer for at least 5 years. - 10.1.2 Records of injuries to employees are kept for 10 years. - 10.1.3 Tracker and dashcam data linked to Level 3 or 4 incidents is kept until any insurance or legal matter is closed, and for at least 5 years.

10.2 **Reporting** - 10.2.1 The HSE Manager sends a monthly safety report to the COO by the 7th of each month. It covers incident numbers by level, lost-time injuries, near-misses and overdue actions. - 10.2.2 Trends are reviewed quarterly at the management meeting.

10.3 **Confidentiality.** Personal and medical details in incident records are shared only with those who need them for investigation, insurance or legal purposes.

11. Revision History

Version	Effective date	Summary of changes

Version	Effective date	Summary of changes
1.0	1 March 2026	First issue. Brings together incident rules previously in IFL-OPS-003 v1.1 and IFL-SAF-004 v1.0; adds severity levels, night/holiday escalation and post-incident testing

Fictional company — created for software demonstration only.